	MANAGEMENT OF NON-CONFORMING WORK (+17025)	
	Document no: ASMF7.17B	
Compiled by:	Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager	
Approved by:	Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager	

Extension of Application – ISO/IEC 17025 Activities

In addition to proficiency testing and reference material production activities, this procedure shall also apply to non-conforming work arising from ISO/IEC 17025 laboratory activities, including but not limited to:

- Testing and calibration activities

- Sampling activities\
- Handling of test items
- Application of test or calibration methods
- Calculation, verification, and reporting of results
- Equipment use and calibration status
- Environmental conditions affecting results
- Additional Scope (ISO/IEC 17025 Context)

This procedure also applies to:

• Invalid or suspect test or calibration results

• Use of uncalibrated or malfunctioning equipment

- Failure to follow approved methods or SOPs
- Environmental conditions outside specified limits
- Incorrect, incomplete, or unauthorised test reports
- Staff competency or authorisation failures
- Data integrity or transcription errors

Additional Responsibilities (ISO/IEC 17025 Context)

Role | Responsibility

Technical Manager/ Laboratory Supervisor : Assess technical validity of affected test/calibration results and decide on re-testing or re-sampling

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Effective date	Rev status	Next review date
02/2026	00	02/2029

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Laboratory Manager: Ensure compliance with ISO/IEC 17025 clauses 7.10 and 8.7 and ensure records are maintained

Lab Manager: Authorise suspension of testing where result validity is in question

Additional Procedure – ISO/IEC 17025 Nonconforming Work Handling

A. Identification of ISO/IEC 17025 Nonconforming Work

Nonconforming work may be identified from:

- QC failures or control chart breaches
- Failed method verification or validation checks
- Proficiency testing failures
- Equipment calibration out-of-tolerance results
- Deviations from approved test methods
- Review of test reports prior to release
- Complaints related to test/calibration results

B. Immediate Actions (ISO/IEC 17025 Context)

In addition to Section 5:

- Suspend testing or calibration activities where result validity may be compromised
- Quarantine affected test items or data
- Prevent release of affected reports
- Identify and segregate all work potentially affected

C. Evaluation of Impact on Results

The evaluation shall determine whether:

- Previously reported test/calibration results are invalid
- Customers require notification
- Results require withdrawal, amendment, or reissue
- Re-sampling or re-testing is required

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- Accreditation scope is affected

D. Customer Notification (ISO/IEC 17025 Context)

Where nonconforming work affects reported results:

- Customers shall be notified in writing without undue delay
- The notification shall include:
  - Description of the nonconformity
  - Impact on reported results
  - Proposed corrective action
  - Options for re-testing or re-sampling

E. Authorization to Resume Work

Testing or calibration activities shall only resume once:

- Root cause has been identified
- Corrective actions have been implemented
- Effectiveness has been verified
- Authorization has been granted by the Laboratory Manager or Technical Manager

Additional Documentation Requirements (ISO/IEC 17025 Context)

The Improvement Action Request Form shall also include:

- Identification of affected test/calibration reports
- Decision on validity of results
- Customer notification date
- Authorization to resume work
- Technical Manager approval

Risk-Based Thinking (ISO/IEC 17025 Context)

Nonconforming work related to ISO/IEC 17025 activities shall be evaluated for:

- Risk to result validity
- Risk to customer confidence

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- Risk to accreditation status
- Risk of recurrence

Risks shall be recorded in the risk register and reviewed during management review.

Records (ISO/IEC 17025 Context)

Records shall include:

- NCW records for test and calibration activities
- Impact assessments
- Customer notifications
- Amended or withdrawn reports
- Corrective action records

Records shall be retained in accordance with Section 10 and the record control procedure.

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